

# Cool Stuff on Linux — A Reference Guide for Adventurous Newcomers

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## Q 1) Research Skills & Problem Solving

**Goal:** Learn how to find answers fast when the terminal throws tantrums. **What to do:**

- Search the **man pages** (`man rsync`, `man bash`) — the classic built-in Linux docs.
- Use `apropos`, `man -k`, `--help` flags.
- Stack Exchange (Unix & Linux), distro forums and reddit are gold mines.

 **Tips:** always check dates & distro versions — old scripts can break what you have achieved.

→ Unix & Linux Q&A sorted by votes: *awesome community answers* (Learn By Example)

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## 2) Learn FFmpeg

FFmpeg is your **multimedia Swiss Army knife** — convert, cut, encode audio & video from the terminal.

 **Tutorial:** *Install and Use ffmpeg in Linux* — super clear with examples.

→ <https://itsfoss.com/ffmpeg/> (It's FOSS)

 **Main Documentation**

→ <https://ffmpeg.org/ffmpeg.html>

**Basics:**

```
# convert an MKV to MP4
$ ffmpeg -i input.mkv output.mp4
```

Fun hack: use FFmpeg to record your screen or trim clips like a wizard. ✂

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## 🔄 3) FOSS Alternatives for Common Software

Why pay or use closed source when Linux offers freedom (and bragging rights)?

**Check out:**

- LibreOffice → Office suite
- GIMP → Photoshop replacement
- Inkscape → vector graphics
- Blender → 3D beast
- Audacity → audio editing
- Krita → painting/art

→ Neowin guide on top FOSS apps for Linux → <https://www.neowin.net/guides/...>  
(Neowin)  
Also use AlternativeTo.net for more suggestions.

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## 🖱 4) Run Windows Apps/Games with Bottles, Wine, Proton & Lutris

Welcome to **Windows software on Linux** land!

**Tech stack:**

- **Wine** — compatibility layer to run many Windows apps and games. (Wikipedia)
- **Bottles** — GUI wineprefix & dependency manager. (GamingOnLinux)
- **Proton** — Wine optimized for games, built into Steam. (Wikipedia)
- **Lutris** — game launcher & scripts installer. (Wikipedia)

### Tutorials & resources:

- Bottles + Wine on YouTube: [https://youtu.be/xGbQZt96q54?si=FgQJ\\_\\_YMpISs7L1c](https://youtu.be/xGbQZt96q54?si=FgQJ__YMpISs7L1c) (YouTube)
- Lutris: <https://youtu.be/JXHvGjiJJG0?si=1fI81xIr7zichNDy>
- ProtonDB (community compatibility data — must bookmark).

 **Tip:** Steam + Proton is often easiest for games; Lutris handles other launchers & installers.

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## 5) Learn rsync

**rsync** is a *super efficient* file sync tool — perfect for backups and transfers.

 **Guide:** DigitalOcean tutorial — concise, example-rich.

→ (DigitalOcean)

 **Youtube Tutorial**

→ Backing up a Linux Server with rsync

### Key command patterns:

```
# basic local sync
$ rsync -av /src/ /dest/

# remote sync
$ rsync -avz /src/ user@host:/dest/
```

Learn the difference trailing slash makes — it's the "slash of power" .

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## 6) Using AI on Linux

AI tools are popping up everywhere — including Linux!

- GPT models locally: GPT4All, Ollama, etc.
- Online AI models.

- AI helpers can summarize logs, optimize scripts, and suggest commands.

### Notable tools:

- GPT4All (local transformers)
- Ollama (local LLM host)
- Bard/ChatGPT in the browser

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## 🔧 7) Install Common GUI Apps

Use apt, **Flatpak**, or **Snap**:

### APT (Debian/Ubuntu):

```
$ sudo apt update
$ sudo apt install vlc gnome-tweaks
```

### Flatpak:

```
$ sudo apt install flatpak
$ flatpak install flathub com.obsproject.Studio
```

### Snap:

```
$ sudo apt install snapd
$ snap install spotify
```

❗ Snaps auto-update, are sandboxed, and sometimes bigger in size. (Linux Commando)

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## 📦 8) Flatpak & Snap (Universal Packaging)

**Flatpak** — universal, distro-agnostic, sandboxed. **Snap** — Canonical's system with auto-updates and confinement. Tutorial: Linux learning guide covers both package systems.

### Example commands:

```
$ flatpak search editor
$ snap find browser
```

💡 **Pro tip:** Flatpak often has newer versions than distro repos.

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## ➤ 9) Shell Aliases & Customizations

Aliases save time — like macros for your shell.

```
$ alias ll='ls -la'
$ alias gs='git status'
```

Add to ~/.bashrc or ~/.zshrc and source ~/.bashrc to reload.  
You'll thank yourself later when typing gets lazy 😊

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## 🔧 10) Install & Configure Common Software

Here's a quick starter pack for Ubuntu:

```
$ sudo apt update
$ sudo apt install \
git htop tmux neofetch \
gufw gnome-tweaks
```

Want a script? Store it in setup.sh and run `bash setup.sh`.  
Also check **Perfect Ubuntu Guide** on GitHub for curated apps & setup tips.

➔ <https://github.com/mikerooyal/Perfect-Ubuntu-Guide> (GitHub)

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## 🎮 11) Fonts & Themes

Make your desktop *pop*:

- Install custom fonts (`sudo apt install fonts-roboto`)
- GNOME Tweaks for themes

- Flatpak themes from Flathub

Fonts + themes = aesthetic ~100% more hipster points 😊

### 📺 Youtube Tutorial

➔ <https://mmbesar.github.io/Tutorials/Best-Arabic-Font-in-Linux/>

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## 🔧 12) Cool Command Line Utilities

Let's finish with **fun CLI tools** you'll use all the time:

- fzf — fuzzy finder wizard
- broot — better directory tree explorer
- bat — cat with syntax highlighting
- htop / btop — fancy process views
- ddgr — DuckDuckGo in terminal

See a huge curated list of utilities (bookmarks worthy).

➔ <https://github.com/Tinram/Linux-Utilities> (GitHub)

### 📺 Youtube Video

➔ 12 GREAT command line programs YOU recommended!

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## 🐧 Wrap-Up

You now have a **jumpstart roadmap** for fun, practical, and beginner-friendly Linux exploration — with links to **quality tutorials** and docs. Dive in, google everything (searching is half the skill 😊), and don't be afraid to break stuff — *that's how mastery happens*.

If you want, I can turn this into a **multi-page PDF or structured course outline** next 🔧.

Happy hacking! 🐧💻

### Helpful Links

- [Linux CLI and Shell scripting | scripting\\_course](#)
- [Install and Use ffmpeg in Linux \[Complete Guide\]](#)
- [Top 10 FOSS apps to make your Linux experience more enjoyable - Neowin](#)
- [Wine \(software\)](#)
- [Use Wine for gaming on Linux? Try out Bottles | GamingOnLinux](#)
- [Proton \(software\)](#)
- [Lutris](#)
- [How to setup Lutris & Bottles in 2025! \(UPDATED GUIDE\) - YouTube](#)
- [How To Use Rsync to Sync Local and Remote Directories](#)
- [Linux Commando: 2018](#)
- [GitHub - mikeroyal/Perfect-Ubuntu-Guide](#)
- [GitHub - Tinram/Linux-Utilities](#)